THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL_SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 2–4: **Reshaping India's Political Map, The Rise of the Marathas, The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Aurangzeb's long stay in the Deccan led to 1

(a) greater trade
(b) end of wars
(c) a drained treasury and weak northern control
(d) more peace

2. Mahadji Shinde's role was important since he 1

(a) ended chauth **(b)** left the Marathas
(c) restored Maratha power in north India **(d)** defeated the British always

3. Railways did NOT mainly benefit Indians because 1

(a) they linked all villages
(b) they were free
(c) lines were planned for British trade and defence
(d) they stopped taxes

4. Fatehpur Sikri shows Akbar's 1

(a) architectural and cultural vision **(b)** defeat
(c) exile **(d)** poverty

5. Which factor made forts central to Maratha strategy? 1

(a) Snowfields **(b)** Hilly terrain **(c)** Deserts **(d)** Flat lands

6. British success in India was helped mainly by 1

(a) Indian unity **(b)** free trade
(c) divide and rule and military strength **(d)** lack of weapons

7. Why did regional dynasties like the Hoysalas build great temples? 1

(a) To display power and devotion **(b)** To please Delhi
(c) As schools only **(d)** Because they had no armies

8. The escape from Agra shows Shivaji's 1

(a) lack of allies **(b)** defeat
(c) quick planning and cleverness **(d)** weak army

9. Why did the Company's private army matter? 1

(a) It let a trading firm win battles and control territory
(b) It protected temples
(c) It built schools
(d) It stopped trade

10. Which was NOT a cause of Mughal decline? 1

(a) Weak successors **(b)** Deccan wars
(c) Rebellions **(d)** Efficient tax collection

11. The cartaz system was 1

(a) a tax on farmers
(b) a law
(c) a land grant
(d) a pass required by European powers for ships

12. Tribal revolts like the Santhal were caused by 1

(a) trade
(b) rain
(c) moneylenders, landlords and colonial laws
(d) railways only

13. Why were Rajput queens' jauhar practices remembered? 1

(a) They show trade
(b) They show coins
(c) They show treaties
(d) They show the lengths taken to preserve honour

14. Shivaji's order regarding trees shows his 1

(a) concern for nature and people **(b)** love of timber
(c) indifference **(d)** disregard for trade

15. Which is an unintended effect of colonial rule? 1

(a) More trade
(b) End of English
(c) Less railways
(d) Spread of new ideas leading to nationalism

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why were forts vital to Maratha defence? 2

17. How did divide and rule help the British? 2

18. Why did Pratap and the Ahoms use guerrilla war? 2

19. Why did Panipat 1761 matter? 2

20. Why did Santhals revolt? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Explain how education policy changed under Macaulay. 3

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22. Compare Babur and Akbar as rulers. 3

23. Describe the cartaz system and the Maratha response. 3

24. Describe the role of Rani Lakshmibai in 1857. 3

OR

Analyse the causes of the fall of Vijayanagara. 3

25. Why did Shivaji need a navy? 3

OR

Explain the role of Plassey in establishing British power. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Analyse the methods by which the East India Company expanded its control. 5

OR

Discuss medieval trade and the role of merchants, ports and hundis. 5

27. Describe the Maratha naval power and its importance in trade. 5

OR

Evaluate the claim that railways were a gift of the British. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

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